



The 2026 Great Game

A Strategic Assessment of Global
Friction, Bureaucratic Sabotage,
and Proxy Warfare.

August 2026



The Dual Vectors of Strategic Friction

The Western Gaze



- **Focus:** Germany and NATO Logistics
- **Tactic:** Bureaucratic Obstruction
- **Mechanism:** Leveraging pro-Kremlin AfD electoral victories to paralyze peacetime military movement.

The Southern Gaze



- **Focus:** Iran and U.S. Outposts
- **Tactic:** Kinetic Proxy Warfare
- **Mechanism:** Supplying intelligence and targeting support to overwhelm depleted U.S. air defenses.

Fracturing the Western Borderlands



The Polling Threat



The Alternative for Germany (AfD) is projected to win 40% of the vote in September state elections.

The Kremlin Link

AfD leaders Alice Weidel and Ulrich Siegmund actively advocate against Russian sanctions and for a return to cheap Russian gas.

The Constitutional Loophole

An absolute majority allows the AfD to form a state government, bypassing the traditional party 'firewall' and gaining control over local internal security and policing.

The Mechanics of NATO's Roundabout

Moving troops to the eastern flank requires activating the Reinforcement and Sustainment Network (RSN). Under peacetime rules, the military is entirely dependent on civilian cooperation for this 5-to-6 week process.



The Bureaucratic Frost

How pro-Kremlin state governments could sabotage a NATO deployment without firing a shot.

Standard NATO Procedures



Expedited clearance for allied troops.



Police clear routes for heavy military transports.



State police secure key infrastructure.

Proposed AfD Blockades

Deliberate bureaucratic delays on civilian permits.

Refusal to grant military priority on local roads.

Withholding state-level police resources during critical mobilization windows.

"If Putin can find the cracks inside the alliance on a political level and exacerbate those, then that's the shortcut to breaking the alliance." — Western Defense Source

❖ Forging Federal Counter-Measures ❖

Chancellor Friedrich Merz and the Christian Democrats (CDU) are drafting secret contingency plans to bypass rogue "traitor states."

Infrastructure Protection: Transferring control of key infrastructure and personnel safety to neighboring, friendly states.

Intelligence Firewalls: Excluding AfD-controlled governments from classified national security briefings.

The Constitutional Dilemma: Tobias Krull (CDU interior committee) notes the central challenge is creating mechanisms to overrule individual states without violating Germany's strict constitutional laws governing state independence.



Shockwaves in the Inner Court

August 2, 2026:
An explosion strikes near a cafe in central Moscow amid an era of heavily heightened domestic security.



Incident Report

- **Casualties:** 21 individuals injured; emergency teams deployed for intensive care.
- **Response:** Security forces immediately cordoned off surrounding streets. Forensic experts are currently analyzing blast site samples.
- **Status:** Authorities are investigating whether the blast was an accident or a deliberate act. No official claim of responsibility has been released.

The Southern Proxy Network

Since February, Iran has fired between 8,000 and 9,000 drones and missiles at targets across the Middle East, directly striking at least nine U.S. outposts since July 9.

Targeted Facilities Include:

- ◆ **Jordan:** Muwaffaq Salti Air Base, Tower 22, Prince Hassan Air Base
- ◆ **Iraq:** Erbil Air Base
- ◆ **Kuwait:** Camp Doha, Ali Al Salem Air Base
- ◆ **Bahrain / Qatar:** Naval Support Activity Sheikh Isa, Al Udeid Air Base



Anatomy of a Swarm

Iran has successfully overwhelmed U.S. interceptor systems using a layered, multi-domain strike methodology.



1. Hypersonic Vectors:
Missiles traveling at speeds that dramatically reduce intercept windows.

2. Navigational Evasion:
Munitions equipped with complex anti-jamming capabilities to bypass electronic warfare defenses.

3. Guided Trajectories:
Steerable ballistic missiles combined with low-flying attack drones to saturate radar arrays.

The Depletion Equation

The Burn Rate

- The U.S. and allies burned through over 11,000 munitions in the first 16 days of the conflict.
- Strategic defense systems (Patriot and THAAD) have been severely weakened, forcing the U.S. to allow missiles through unless they directly imperil lives.



The Bottleneck

- It will take three or more years to return to prewar inventory levels for advanced interceptors.
- U.S. forces recently suspended a two-week airstrike campaign due to these dwindling defensive stocks.

The Human Cost of Depletion

Despite claims that the military had “every possible measure” to protect troops, overhead protection and interceptors have failed to prevent U.S. casualties.



Muwaffaq Salti Air Base (Jordan):

Pvt. Isabella Gonzales (19), Lt. Tyler James Feehan (25),
Sgt. Angel S. Rampersad (28).
Air defense unit members caught in the strike.

Erbil Air Base (Iraq):

Army Sgt. Michael Emmanuel
Swinton (30). Killed during
a controlled detonation of
a downed Iranian drone.

Hundreds more U.S. personnel have been wounded, a figure whistleblowers describe as an active casualty cover-up.

Uncovering the Hidden Strings

The Iranian swarm is not acting in isolation. It is heavily subsidized by great power adversaries utilizing the Middle East as a proxy theater.

Russian Assistance

Defense consultants confirm Russia has provided critical “targeting support” to Iran, reportedly aiding in strikes against covert CIA CIA sites in the region.



The Intelligence Request

CIA Director John Ratcliffe confirmed to the Senate that Iran actively requested intelligence assistance from both Moscow and Beijing to optimize their strike packages against U.S. assets.

The 2026 Synthesis

The illusion of isolated incidents gives way to a unified strategy of global friction.

The Inner Yolk (Moscow)

Maintaining extreme domestic security and managing internal volatility (August 2 Cafe Bombing) while projecting power outward.

The Outer Shell (Europe)

Cultivating domestic political extremism (AfD) to freeze NATO's logistical pathways in peacetime bureaucracy.

The Hidden Core (The Middle East)

Bleeding U.S. defensive stockpiles dry by providing targeting intelligence to Iranian proxy swarms.

Conclusion: The Great Game is no longer fought solely on the battlefield; it is fought in state parliaments, supply chains, and radar arrays.